

Activities and Achievements from APAN60

Hong Kong | July 28 - August 1, 2025



The participants from Bangladesh pose with APAN Chairman during APAN60

The APAN60 event and APAN Conference were held in **Hong Kong from July 28 to August 1, 2025**. The **Bangladesh Research and Education Network (BdREN)** delegation, led by Prof. Dr. S M A Faiz, Chairman of UGC and Chairperson of BdREN, participated in the event. The team actively participated in high-level discussions, technical presentations, and strategic networking sessions, reinforcing Bangladesh's position in the Asia-Pacific research and education network community. This global gathering offered a platform to influence policy, showcase innovation, and strengthen collaborations within the research and education networking community. The following notes script BdREN's journey through the sessions that shaped the week.

Objectives of Participation

- Strengthen collaborations with global NRENs.
- Support and promote the next phase of the Asi@Connect project.
- Present BdREN's achievements, innovations, and technical advancements.
- Search for new businesses, promote existing initiatives, arranging grants for new initiative and capacity strengthening.
- Engage in critical discussions on Internet Governance, AI, network security, and research connectivity.
- Gain insights into emerging trends for future strategic planning.
- Take the baton of APAN61 as the next host and officially welcome the APAN community to Dhaka in January 2026.

Asi@Connect Governors' Meeting



Participants in 18th Asi@Connect Governors' Meeting

The Asi@Connect Governors' Meeting was a high-level forum to set strategic directions for the project's next phase. Prof. Dr. S M A Faiz, Chairperson of BdREN, reaffirmed Bangladesh's commitment to regional research and education network connectivity. Dr. Mohammad Farooq Ali Tarafder FCMA, ACS, as a Steering Committee Member, actively participated in shaping strategies for sustainability of the next phase of Asi@Connect project, ensuring Bangladesh's voice in the project's future. In this meeting BdREN's e-Compendium initiative was demonstrated by CEO, BdREN to all the Governors which was highly appreciated and it was resolved to be implemented at the soonest.

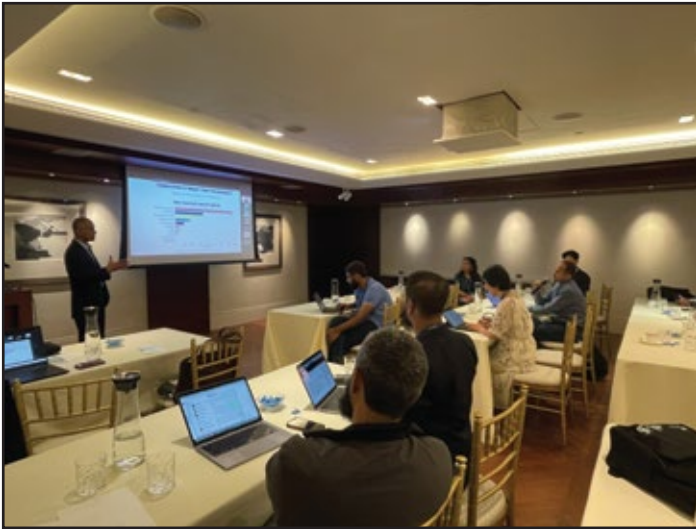


Sneak Peak from Asi@Connect Steering Committee Meeting

On the preceding day, Dr. Farooq participated in the Asi@Connect Steering Committee Meeting—a preparatory session traditionally held before the Governors' Meeting to develop agendas and other inputs that guide the discussions at the high-level forum.

SIG: INTERNET GOVERNANCE

Impact Analysis of Internet Fragmentation and Shaping the Future of the Internet



This session addressed one of the most pressing issues in global internet policy: the threat of fragmentation of the internet. Chaired by Mohammad Tawrit, CEO of BdREN, discussions centered on understanding the potential impacts, exploring governance frameworks, and filling out the Impact Assessment Form for each participatory country.

Speakers included:

- Buseung Cho – KISTI, South Korea.
- Rajan Parajuli – NREN, Nepal.
- Changqing An- Tsinghua University, China.
- Md. Ariful Islam – BdREN, Bangladesh.
- Wathsala Dayananda – LEARN, Sri Lanka.
- Fawad Raza – PERN, Pakistan.

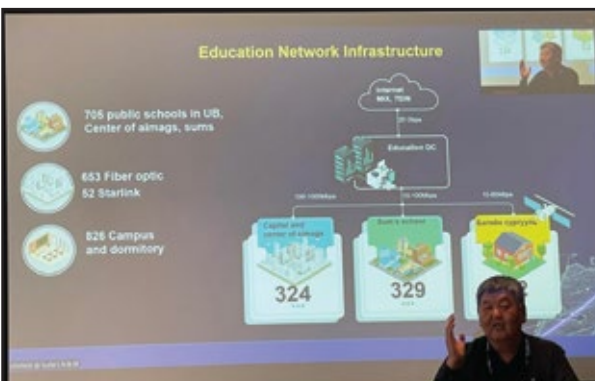


Their contributions provided diverse insights—from technical measures to policy-level recommendations—on safeguarding an open, interoperable and inclusive internet.



SIG: Emerging NRENs

Flagship Achievements, Future Plans, and Enhancement of Collaborations

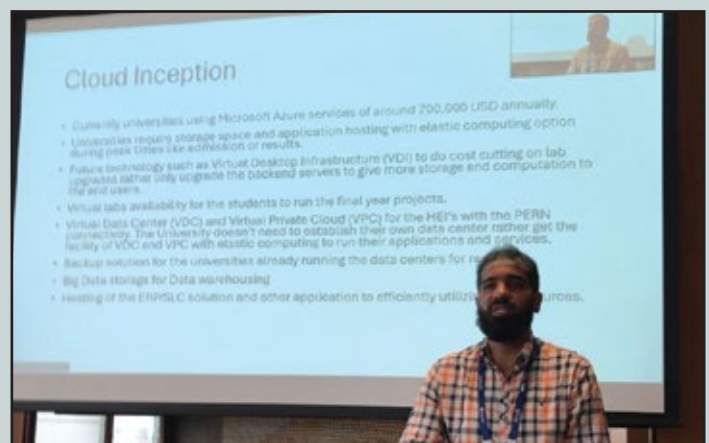


Spanning two back-to-back sessions chaired by Mohammad Tawrit, this SIG spotlighted the progress and ambitions of rapidly growing NRENs. Discussions focused on:

- Key achievements over the past six months.
- Planned initiatives for the near future.
- Regional Collaboration initiated through projects like HEAT and ARENA-PAC.
- NREN-Private organization partnership: an example set by GSS and BdREN through development of "Orbit Event Management Application".

Future collaboration and funding opportunities were explored, through regional projects like HEAT (Bangladesh) and ARENA-PAC where Project Director, HEAT Prof. Asaduzzaman narrated about the available scope under HEAT and ARENA-PAC projects respectively. Representatives from BdREN, DrukREN, PERN, ErdemNet and NREN, shared updates and perspectives. Nafew of BdREN, demonstrated the "MindSpear" Application (developed on implementation of AI) and e-mail client application (in Gmail and other dedicated mail server also built on AI) which enchanted the audiences.

Shaan of Global Support System (GSS) from Malaysia came up with the BdREN-GSS initiative in developing the event management software application which was used in APAN60. He urged other NRENs to emerge with such initiatives to enhance their sustainability.



BGPWatch: Project Update, Partner Insights, and Future Planning

The BGPWatch session showcased collaborative efforts to improve routing transparency and network stability. CEO, BdREN demonstrated the benefits of BGPWatch platform, a joint venture of Tsinghua University and regional NRENs which was funded by APNIC, and also recommended on enrichment of the platform.

Speakers included:

- Mohammad Tawrit – BdREN, Bangladesh.
- Changqing An – Tsinghua University, China.
- Chalermopol Charnsripinyo – ThaiREN, Thailand.

Together, they discussed about enriching the platform and integrating the latter with other peers to enhance its usage.



CEO-BdREN poses for photographs with the speakers and participants of BGPWatch session



AP-GAINED WORKSHOP



The AP-GAINED Workshop was a hub for capacity development and skill exchange, focusing on AI adoption and research connectivity being implemented by LEARN, Sri Lanka in collaboration with BdREN. Kh. Rashedul Arefin, Manager (Data Center, BdREN), served as a trainer, sharing practical insights for AI integration with NREN services.

Representatives from BdREN member institutions—Prof. Dr. Fazlul Hasan Siddiqui (DUET), Brig. Gen. Omar Faruque Khan (BUP), and Mr. Nasir Ahmed Bhuiyan (BUET)—also took part in the event and were awarded certificates for their successful participation, marking recognition of their engagement and contributions.



“As a part of BdREN team, I am delighted and privileged to attend an event of such stature. I feel proud to see the commitment of BdREN towards the APAN community and its leadership role in regional capacity building. Attending APAN60 was a real-time experience and knowledge-enhancing event for me and I express my gratitude to BdREN and APAN for inviting me to such an intellectual gathering of academics, researchers and tech experts.”

Brigadier General Omar Faruque Khan, Chief ICT Officer, BUP

“Attending APAN60 in Hong Kong was a great learning experience where I explored cutting-edge topics like Generative AI, HPC, IPv6, and network automation. The sessions and workshops provided practical insights for improving research and education networks. Most importantly, I built valuable connections with global experts, fostering collaboration for future projects.”

-Prof. Dr. Fazlul Hasan Siddiqui, Department of Computer Science and Engineering, Director, Computer Center and ICT Cell, DUET, Gazipur



“The APAN60 meeting was an amazing experience for me. Numerous fascinating workgroups were engaged in various areas of cutting-edge technologies. I was particularly interested in the AP-GAINED group, where I actively participated in all eight sessions and completed the tasks assigned to me. My efforts were recognized with a certificate of participation, which I deeply appreciate.”

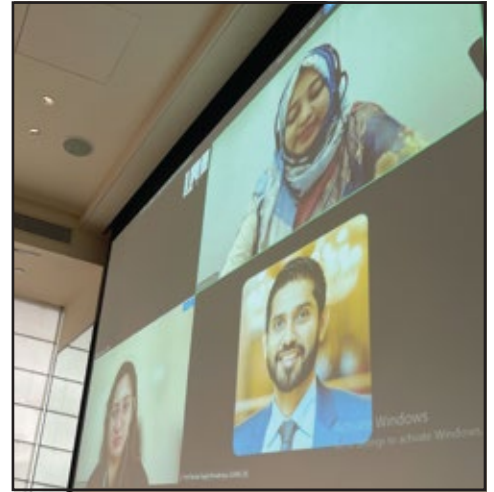
-Nasir Ahmed Bhuiyan, Maintenance Engineer Grade - 1, IICT, BUET



SIG: NREN LEADERS FORUM



The NREN Leaders Forum session was held at APAN60 as a continuation of the event's regular session for NREN leaders to connect, share strategic insights, and collectively shape the future of research and education networking in the Asia-Pacific region.



During this inaugural session, Dr. Farooq, CAFO, BdREN and Ms. Khadizatul Kubra, Assistant Manager (Finance & Accounts), BdREN, who joined the forum online, shared their key takeaways from participating in the Asi@Connect's Global Leadership Development Program-2025 held in Bangkok, Thailand. Their reflections offered valuable perspectives on leadership development among the existing and budding leaders of NRENs under Asi@Connect. They along with Wathsala Dayananda of LEARN expressed their extreme satisfaction to be a part of the training program.

HUAWEI INTELLIGENT EDUCATION FORUM 2025



The forum was followed by an official dinner and cultural program hosted by Huawei, providing an opportunity for informal networking and cultural exchange among participants from multiple countries. This engagement strengthened BdREN's connections with technology partners and showcased the shared vision for intelligent education infrastructure in the region.

On July 30, 2025, the BdREN cohort attended the Huawei Intelligent Education Forum 2025, arranged on the sidelines of the conference. The event brought together education technology leaders and innovators to explore how advanced ICT solutions can empower teaching, learning, and research across the Asia-Pacific.



OTHER AGENDA MEETINGS

APAN ANNUAL GENERAL MEETING

On the sidelines of the APAN60 Conference, the Annual General Meeting of APAN was held on July 31, 2025. Mohammad Tawrit, CEO of BdREN, and Dr. Mohammad Farooq Ali Tarafder, CAFO of BdREN, attended the meeting, representing BdREN at the APAN House. AGMs typically feature updates and outcomes from various Working Groups,

providing members with insights into ongoing initiatives and research collaborations, financial status plans and programs to be conducted, membership fees and other critical policy-level issues. Fellowship programs were also reviewed as a key agenda item. During the meeting, acknowledging the value of broader participation, the proposal of hosting APAN in a hybrid format was unanimously accepted, even though it was concurred that it often involves added complexities in management and execution. To demonstrate BdREN's commitment to APAN's collaborative initiatives, CEO, BdREN offered its institutional Zoom licenses for APAN's future use.



PROGRAM COMMITTEE MEETING

During the APAN60 Program Committee Meeting, host JUCC shared updates on event arrangements, including financing, participation, and recommendations for future hosts. Later, Mohammad Imam Hosen from BdREN made a captivating presentation on plans for APAN61 in Dhaka, highlighting the venue, key tourist attractions, and visa requirements for Bangladesh. BdREN CEO Mohammad Tawrit and CAFO Dr. Mohammad Farooq Ali Tarafder were also present.

"After the event, you won't just talk about the conference sessions—you will be raving about the music, the food, and the friendships you will make. That's the magic of Bangladesh. And at APAN61, we're bringing that magic to you." - Imam quipped.



ASI@CONNECT SUB-PROJECT MEETING

At the Asi@Connect Sub-Project Meeting, BdREN CEO Mohammad Tawrit presented on “Bridging the Digital Divide through North-South Collaboration,” showcasing partnership-driven approaches to expand NREN services. The presentation focused on the huge success of the distance learning projects, which allowed the participating NRENs (BdREN, LEARN, NREN and DrukREN) to stamp their footprint in respective countries.



SIDE MEETINGS

Tri-party Meeting – BdREN, TEIN*CC, and NORDUnet

A tri-party meeting between BdREN CEO Mohammad Tawrit, TEIN*CC (represented by Patch Lee), and NORDUnet (represented by Lars Fischer) discussed the enrichment of eduMEET through collaboration between the Asi@Connect project and NORDUnet. Lars Fischer showed his interest in helping the Asi@Connect community by extending NORDUnet's consultancy. Patch Lee from TEIN*CC also demonstrated his urge in utilizing the mentorship of NORDUnet to enrich eduMEET Video Conferencing application. CEO, BdREN agreed to provide the Software Developer to enrich the application in line with the consultancy to be offered by NORDUnet.

Meeting with GSS

A meeting between BdREN and Global Support Services (GSS) explored opportunities to extend collaboration. Mohammad Tawrit from BdREN and Shaan and Liana from GSS were present in the meeting. They discussed about the status of the implementation of different modules under the contract signed between BdREN and GSS. CEO, BdREN enquired about the public availability of the 'Orbit' event management application. GSS representatives mentioned some of the pending issues with the application which needs to be fixed before making it available for public use. Also, GSS representative pushed CEO, BdREN to finish other modules like finance, HRM, and IT at the earliest. CEO, BdREN extended his firm commitment.

Fellowship and Orbit Event Management



The APAN fellows recieved certifiacates and gift at the closing ceremony

BdREN's role extended beyond the sessions into operational excellence. Through an APAN fellowship, Mohammad Imam Hosen contributed to event logistics, technical support, and presented BdREN's preparations on hosting APAN61 to the APAN Program Committee. In parallel, Latifur Rahman, Software Engineer, BdREN managed the Orbit Event Management Software, co-developed with GSS, streamlining registration, scheduling, and session tracking for APAN60.



"I feel honored to represent my country on this stage and to contribute to such a prestigious event. It has been a great opportunity to build friendships with fellows from different countries and cultures. I would like to extend a warm invitation to all my APAN fellows to join us at APAN61 in Dhaka." Quoted Imam, during APAN fellows' Meeting.

LOOKING AHEAD

APAN60 was more than a conference for BdREN—it was an opportunity to influence governance, showcase innovation, build capacity, and contribute to operational excellence. With the baton now passed, BdREN prepares to host APAN61 in Dhaka, January 26–30, 2026, ready to welcome the global R&E networking community to Bangladesh's capital.

BdREN and the HEAT Project will co-host APAN61 in Dhaka from January 26–30, 2026, presenting an opportunity to showcase Bangladesh's advancements in research and education networking on a global stage.

Prof. Dr. SMA Faiz officially invited the APAN community to APAN61 during the closing ceremony saying,

"On behalf of BdREN and the Higher Education Acceleration and Transformation Project, I warmly invite all members of the APAN community and stakeholders to join us at APAN 61 in the bustling Dhaka city. We will do everything possible to make your entry and stay in Bangladesh smooth and welcoming."

CONCLUSION

APAN60 provided BdREN with a platform to create new business initiative, new collaboration, grab new opportunities influence policy, display technological innovations, and solidify strategic alliances. This momentum will drive future advancements as Bangladesh prepares to host APAN61.



Chairperson, BdREN formally imparts invitation to APAN61 (Left). CEO, BdREN shares updates on the sessions chaired by him (Right).

BdREN and the Higher Education Acceleration and Transformation (HEAT) Project jointly extend a warm invitation to the global APAN community to join APAN61, to be held from January 26–30, 2026, in the vibrant city of Dhaka. We look forward to welcoming the esteemed participants to Bangladesh for an inspiring week of collaboration, innovation, and shared vision.



APAN61 AWATS YOU..

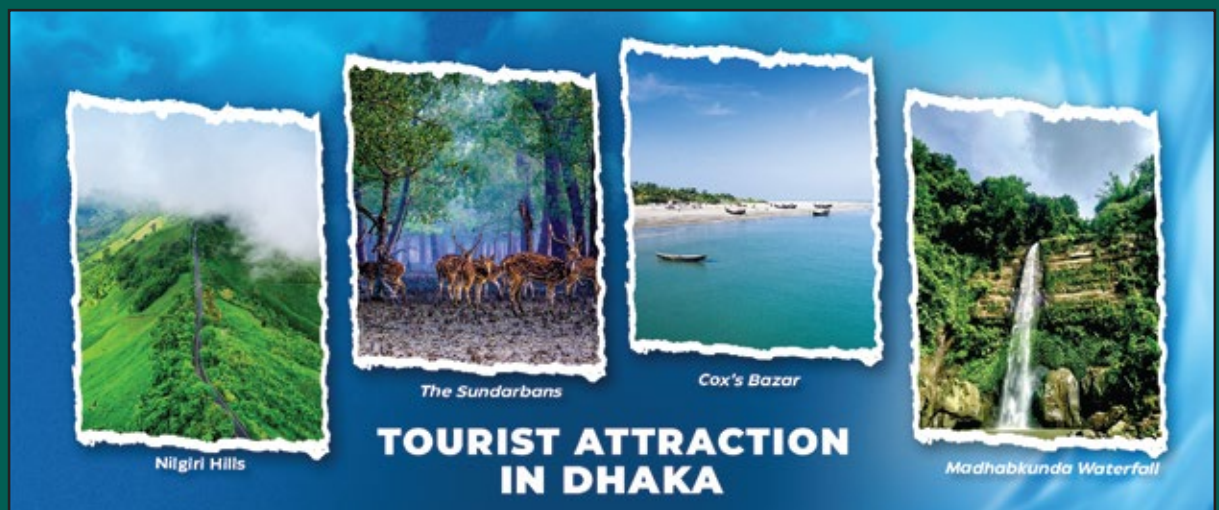
► A vibrant, very hospitable and colourful capital city



Organized by BdREN & HEAT Project with seamless logistics and care ◀



► Cultural immersion with modern amenities and envious hospitality



Mark your calendar: January 26-30, 2026